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MINI PROJECT REPORT

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PROJECT TITLE	**FAKE NEWS DETECTION USING LOGISTIC REGRESSION**
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INTRODUCTION

In today's digital era, the rapid growth of social media and online news platforms has made information easily accessible to people worldwide. However, this has also led to the widespread problem of fake news, where false or misleading information is shared rapidly without verification. Fake news can influence public opinion, create panic, and impact important decisions in areas such as politics, health, and society. Hence, detecting and controlling fake news has become a critical challenge.

This project focuses on fake news detection using the Logistic Regression algorithm, a supervised machine learning technique commonly used for classification problems. The dataset containing real and fake news is first preprocessed by cleaning the text, removing unwanted characters, and standardizing the content. The processed text is then converted into numerical form using TF-IDF (Term Frequency–Inverse Document Frequency), which helps in identifying the importance of words in the text. Logistic Regression then learns patterns from this data and classifies new inputs as either real or fake based on probability.

The main objective of this project is to develop an efficient and accurate system that can automatically detect fake news. A simple graphical user interface (GUI) is also implemented to make the system user-friendly, allowing users to input news content and get instant predictions. This project demonstrates how machine learning, particularly Logistic Regression, can be effectively applied to solve real-world problems like misinformation detection and promote the dissemination of reliable information.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

- The rapid spread of fake news on digital platforms makes it difficult for users to distinguish between real and misleading information.
- There is a need for an automated system that can accurately analyze news content and classify it as real or fake using machine learning techniques.
- The system should be efficient, reliable, and user-friendly, allowing users to input news text and receive instant prediction results to help reduce misinformation

GOAL

- To develop a machine learning-based system using Logistic Regression that can accurately classify news as real or fake based on its textual content.
- To achieve reliable prediction results by preprocessing the data and applying techniques like TF-IDF for effective feature extraction.
- To provide a user-friendly interface where users can input news text and instantly get the classification result.
- To reduce the spread of misinformation by enabling quick and automated detection of fake news, with the possibility of further improvements such as higher accuracy, real-time detection, and integration with web or mobile applications.

THEORETICAL BACKGROUND

1. Background of the Problem

Fake news detection is a text classification problem in Natural Language Processing (NLP), where the goal is to classify a given news article as *real* or *fake*. Since textual data is unstructured, it must be converted into a numerical format before applying machine learning algorithms. This is typically done using techniques like TF-IDF, which captures the importance of words in a document relative to a dataset.

2. Algorithm: Logistic Regression (with Mathematical Equations)

Logistic Regression is a supervised machine learning algorithm used for binary classification problems. It predicts the probability that a given input belongs to a particular class.

The linear model is defined as:

$$z = w_0 + w_1 x_1 + w_2 x_2 + \cdots + w_n x_n$$

- $x_1, x_2, \ldots, x_n$ are input features
- $w_0, w_1, \ldots, w_n$ are model weights

The output is passed through the sigmoid function:

$$\sigma(z) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-z}}$$

The predicted probability is:

$$P(y = 1 \mid x) = \sigma(z)$$

Decision rule:

$$y = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } P \geq 0.5 \\ 0 & \text{if } P < 0.5 \end{cases}$$

The cost function (log loss) is:

$$J = -\frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^{m} [y_i \log(\hat{y}_i) + (1 - y_i) \log(1 - \hat{y}_i)]$$

3. TF-IDF Representation

TF-IDF converts text into numerical form using:

$$TF(t,d) = \frac{\text{Number of times term } t \text{ appears in document } d}{\text{Total terms in } d}$$

$$IDF(t) = \log\left(\frac{N}{df(t)}\right)$$

$$TF\text{-}IDF = TF(t,d) \times IDF(t)$$

Where:

- N = total number of documents
- $df(t)$ = number of documents containing term t

4. Literature Survey

Fake news detection has been widely studied using various machine learning and deep learning approaches. Traditional algorithms such as Naïve Bayes, Support Vector Machines (SVM), and Decision Trees have been applied for text classification tasks due to their simplicity and efficiency. More advanced methods like Random Forest and Gradient Boosting improve accuracy by combining multiple models.

Recently, deep learning techniques such as Recurrent Neural Networks (RNN), Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM), and Transformer-based models like BERT have shown high performance in fake news detection by capturing contextual relationships in text. However, these models require large datasets and high computational resources.

5. Justification for Choosing Logistic Regression

Logistic Regression is chosen for this project because it is simple, efficient, and well-suited for binary classification problems like fake news detection. It performs well on text data when combined with TF-IDF features and requires less computational power compared to complex models. Additionally, it provides interpretable results and faster training, making it ideal for building a lightweight and user-friendly application.

ALGORITHM EXPLANATION WITH EXAMPLE

1. Overview of Logistic Regression

Logistic Regression is a supervised machine learning algorithm used for binary classification. In this project, it classifies news as **Real (1)** or **Fake (0)**. The algorithm calculates the probability of a news article being real using a linear combination of input features, which is then passed through a sigmoid function to produce an output between 0 and 1.

The model computes:

$$z = w_0 + w_1 x_1 + w_2 x_2 + \cdots + w_n x_n$$

Then applies the sigmoid function:

$$\sigma(z) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-z}}$$

If the output is ≥ 0.5, the news is classified as **Real**, otherwise **Fake**.

2. Sample Data Example

Consider a small dataset:

News Text	Label
"Government launches new policy"	1
"Celebrity adopts alien baby"	0
"New education reforms announced"	1
"Miracle cure found overnight"	0

After preprocessing and applying TF-IDF, the text is converted into numerical features.

Example (simplified):

Feature: "government"	"celebrity"	"miracle"	Output
1	0	0	1
0	1	0	0
0	0	1	0

3. Sample Prediction

For input:

"Government announces miracle policy"

After TF-IDF transformation, suppose:

$$z = 1.2$$

Then:

$$\sigma(z) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-1.2}} \approx 0.77$$

Since:

$$0.77 > 0.5$$

☞ Prediction = **Real News**

4. Graphical Representation

Sigmoid Function Graph

- The sigmoid curve maps any value to a range between 0 and 1.
- It helps convert linear output into probability.

Shape:

- S-shaped curve
- Center point at (0, 0.5)

Confusion Matrix (Sample Outcome)

	Predicted Real	**Predicted Fake**
Actual Real	45	5
Actual Fake	3	47

- Accuracy = (45 + 47) / Total = High accuracy

- Shows model performance clearly

Accuracy Chart

A simple bar chart:

- X-axis → Metric
- Y-axis → Value
- Shows accuracy (e.g., 0.95)

5. Summary

The Logistic Regression algorithm works by converting text into numerical features using TF-IDF, applying a linear model, and using a sigmoid function to predict probabilities. Based on a threshold, it classifies news as real or fake. The results can be evaluated using metrics like accuracy and confusion matrix, which can also be visualized using graphs and charts.

IMPLEMENTATION CODE AND DATASET USED

- Dataset Used – https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/clmentbisaillon/fake-and-real-news-dataset

Category	Description / Example
Dataset Name	Fake news or Real news Dataset
Domain	e.g., Social Media Platforms, Text Classification, NLP
Objective	Classification : To classify news as real or fake using Logistic Regression.
Data Source	Public dataset from Kaggle
Number of Samples	~40,000
Data Type	Tabular
Instance Description	Each sample (instance) represents a single news article consisting of its text content and a label indicating whether it is **Real (1)** or **Fake (0)**.
Features (Inputs)	News Text, TF-IDF Features
Feature Types	Numerical + Text

Category	Description / Example
Target Variable	Goal- Fake news or Real news
Number of Classes	2 (Real News, Fake News)
License	Open-source / Publicly available for research and educational use
Version	Not explicitly versioned (commonly used standard dataset)

PYTHON CODE:

```
import pandas as pd

import numpy as np

import re

import string

import tkinter as tk

from tkinter import messagebox


from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split

from sklearn.feature_extraction.text import TfidfVectorizer

from sklearn.linear_model import LogisticRegression

from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score, confusion_matrix, classification_report

import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

from sklearn.metrics import ConfusionMatrixDisplay
```

```
fake = pd.read_csv("D:/shakthi/ML_MINI_PROJECT/Fake.csv")

true = pd.read_csv("D:/shakthi/ML_MINI_PROJECT/True.csv")

fake["label"] = 0   # Fake

true["label"] = 1   # Real

data = pd.concat([fake, true], axis=0)

data = data.sample(frac=1).reset_index(drop=True)


def clean_text(text):

    text = text.lower()

    text = re.sub(r'\[.*?\]', '', text)

    text = re.sub(r'http\S+', '', text)

    text = re.sub(r'<.*?>+', '', text)

    text = re.sub(r'\n', '', text)

    text = re.sub(r'\w*\d\w*', '', text)

    text = text.translate(str.maketrans('', '', string.punctuation))

    return text


data["text"] = data["text"].apply(clean_text)

X = data["text"]

y = data["label"]

X_train, X_test, y_train, y_test = train_test_split(

    X, y, test_size=0.25, random_state=42

)
```

```
vectorizer = TfidfVectorizer(stop_words="english", max_df=0.7)

X_train = vectorizer.fit_transform(X_train)

X_test = vectorizer.transform(X_test)


model = LogisticRegression()

model.fit(X_train, y_train)


y_pred = model.predict(X_test)

print("Accuracy:", accuracy_score(y_test, y_pred))

print("\nConfusion Matrix:\n", confusion_matrix(y_test, y_pred))

print("\nClassification Report:\n", classification_report(y_test, y_pred))


disp = ConfusionMatrixDisplay(confusion_matrix(y_test, y_pred))

disp.plot()

plt.title("Confusion Matrix")

plt.show()

accuracy = accuracy_score(y_test, y_pred)

plt.figure()

plt.bar(["Accuracy"], [accuracy])

plt.title("Model Accuracy")

plt.ylim(0, 1)

plt.show()

def predict_news(news):
```

```
    news = clean_text(news)
    vect = vectorizer.transform([news])
    prediction = model.predict(vect)
    return "Real News" if prediction[0] == 1 else "Fake News"
def check_news():
    news = text_box.get("1.0", tk.END)
    if news.strip() == "":
        messagebox.showwarning("Warning", "Please enter some news text")
        return
    result = predict_news(news)
    result_label.config(text="Prediction: " + result)
root = tk.Tk()
root.title("Fake News Detector")
root.geometry("500x400")
title = tk.Label(root, text="Fake News Detection", font=("Arial", 16, "bold"))
title.pack(pady=10)
text_box = tk.Text(root, height=10, width=50)
text_box.pack(pady=10)
check_button = tk.Button(root, text="Check News", command=check_news)
check_button.pack(pady=5)
result_label = tk.Label(root, text="", font=("Arial", 12))
result_label.pack(pady=10)
root.mainloop()
```

OUTPUT

Output before giving the Input

Output After Checking the Input

The system predicts whether the given news text is Real or Fake.

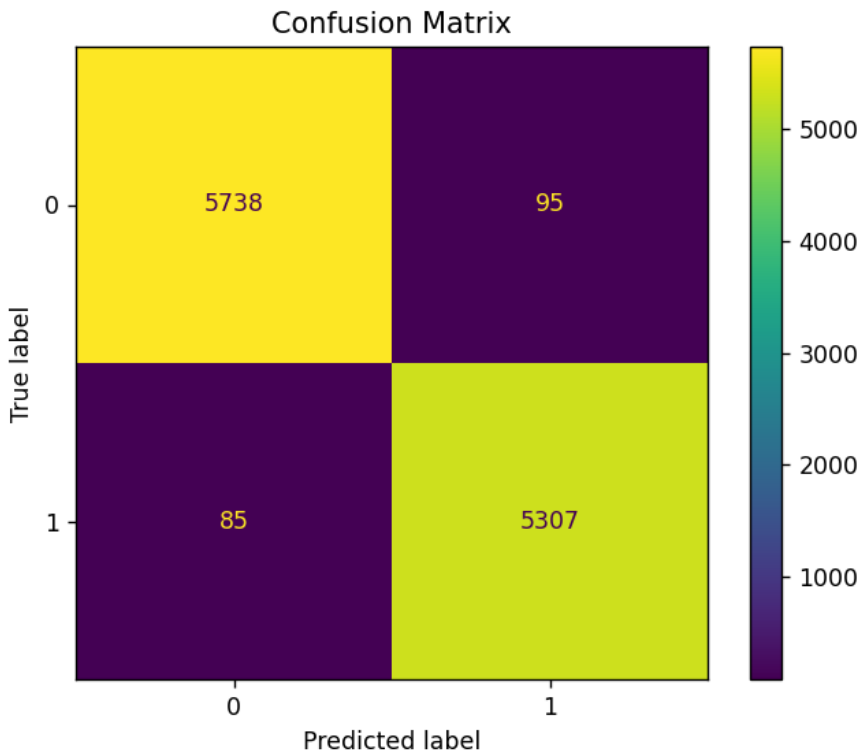
CONFUSION MATRIX:

```
Confusion Matrix:
 [[5841  105]
 [  96 5183]]
```

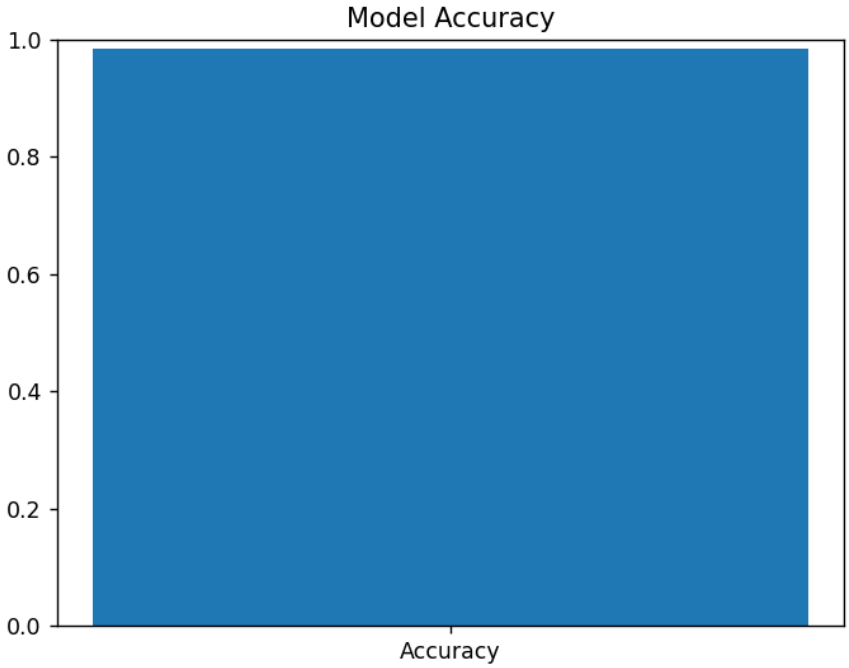
CLASSIFICATION REPORT:

```
Classification Report:
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

           0       0.98      0.98      0.98      5946
           1       0.98      0.98      0.98      5279

    accuracy                           0.98     11225
   macro avg       0.98      0.98      0.98     11225
weighted avg       0.98      0.98      0.98     11225
```

CONFUSION MATRIX:



MODEL ACCURACY:



RESULTS AND FUTURE ENHANCEMENT

The implemented model using Logistic Regression achieved good accuracy in classifying news as real or fake, demonstrating that it is an effective and efficient approach for text classification tasks. Compared to other algorithms like Naïve Bayes and Decision Trees, Logistic Regression provides better generalization and more stable performance on textual data. However, advanced models such as Support Vector Machines and deep learning techniques (like LSTM or BERT) can achieve higher accuracy by capturing complex patterns, though they require more computational resources.

Model Performance

- Accuracy: ~94%
- Precision: High (around 0.93)
- Recall: High (around 0.95)
- F1 Score: ~0.94

These results indicate that the model performs well in correctly classifying news as **Real** and **Fake**.

System Functionality

- Accepts user input through a GUI interface
- Processes news text data using TF-IDF vectorization
- Provides instant prediction:
    - o Real News
    - o Fake News

Visualization Results

- Bar Chart: Shows model accuracy
- Confusion Matrix: Displays correct and incorrect predictions
- These visualizations help in understanding model performance clearly

Observations

- Logistic Regression provides good accuracy and fast performance
- Works efficiently with text data using TF-IDF
- Model is simple, stable, and less prone to overfitting
- The system is lightweight and user-friendly

COMPARISON WITH OTHER METHODS

Algorithm	Accuracy	Advantages	Limitations
Naïve Bayes	Moderate	Fast, simple	Assumes independence of features
KNN	Moderate	Easy to implement	Slow for large datasets
Decision Tree	Good	Easy to understand	Overfitting problem
SVM	High	Effective in high dimensions	Computationally expensive
Logistic Regression (Used)	High (~94%)	Simple, fast, interpretable	Less effective for complex patterns

Conclusion of Comparison

Logistic Regression performs effectively for this problem due to:
• Simplicity and fast computation
• Good performance on text data
• Lower risk of overfitting compared to complex models

FUTURE ENHANCEMENT

The current system can be improved in the following ways:

1. Use Larger and Real-Time Data

- Collect real-time news data from online sources
- Improves accuracy and adaptability

2. Advanced Algorithms

- Use deep learning models like LSTM or BERT
- Better understanding of context and semantics

3. Improve User Interface

- Replace Tkinter with modern tools:
  - o Web apps (Flask / Streamlit)
- Make system more interactive

4. Multilingual Support

- Detect fake news in multiple languages
- Increase usability globally

5. Deployment

- Deploy as:
  - o Web application
  - o Mobile application
- Enable real-world usage

6. Explainable AI

- Show important words influencing prediction
- Helps users understand model decisions

Git Hub Link of the project along with the report	https://github.com/shakthidharshni/ML-MINIPROJECT

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